prevent environmental destruction. A fast he went on in 1981 led to a fifteen-year ban on commercial logging in Uttarakhand.

“IF I DIE, I DIE, BUT WE MUST NOT LET THIS PLACE DIE…IT BELONGS TO US AND TO OUR CHILDREN AND GRANDCHILDREN.”

FATEH SINGH RATHORE

1938–2011



Fateh Singh Rathore was an officer of the Indian Forest Service. In 1973, he was sent to Ranthambhore, a reserve under the Project Tiger programme. In order to protect the park’s tiny tiger population and their habitat, Rathore resettled villages located in the park, and secured bans on activities that would disrupt the ecosystem. He was Field Director of Ranthambhore for ten years and later worked as an independent tiger conservationist, studying and reporting on the park’s growing tiger population. Despite political apathy and even the threat of physical violence, he remained committed to his cause.

MEDHA PATKAR